

5.11.2 Interface and Customising

Granular Linux runs on KDE so a lot of the features and layout of items will seem similar. The menu bar sits on the top of the screen. A list of program shortcuts are on the top right before the virtual desktops list. You'll also find Enlightenment as a part of Granular.

5.11.3 Applications

The Granular Control Center is an important part of the OS. It's a system configuration tool which lets you set up everything from hardware to file sharing on a network. It's visible as a tools icon on the menubar. All the tasks possible are available in the left panel.

Because PCLinuxOS was derived out of Mandriva, Granular too uses the RPM file installation format. It too uses the Synaptic Package Manager. Granular comes with the mklivecd script which allows users to create their own versions of the distribution or even a LiveCD.

Other important Linux Distros

The detailed install guidelines above should make you comfortable with installing most Linux distros. There are a few derivative distros, and distros used for particular purposes. The list of distros are preferred by their users depending on how they are used, or how they function. After trying out their first distro, most Linux enthusiasts cycle through a wide range of distros in an attempt to find the one most suitable to them. In fact, many do this habitually, going on to the latest distro available, just because of some improvements in the releases of the other distros. This short guide should help you select the pick of the lot for your needs:

5.12 Other important Linux distributions

5.12.1 Arch Linux

Arch Linux is one of those distros that follow the KISS principle. Arch is similar to Slackware in many ways, but has a few improvements. If you are installing Arch Linux, refer to the Slackware installation guide, as the two are pretty similar. Arch Linux has rolling updates, which are more frequent than Fedora or Gentoo, and hence require a constant Internet connection. Arch Linux is geared towards engineers, coders or command line enthusiasts. Arch Linux has a large repository, and the